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Out in the open: Open Access, preprints and postprints

FELIX SCHÖNBRODT & SARAH VON GREBMER ZU WOLFSTHURN
LMU OPEN SCIENCE CENTER (OSC)

Last update: 30.9.2026

About these materials



These slides and materials were adapted from previous work by Prof. Dr. Felix Schönbrodt (<https://orcid.org/0000-0002-8282-3910>). They were subsequently modified by Dr. Sarah von Grebmer (<https://orcid.org/0000-0002-6413-3895>) and are licensed under CC-BY 4.0 (<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/deed.en>). You are free to share (copy and redistribute the material in any medium or format) and adapt (remix, transform, and build upon the material) for any purpose, even commercially, as long as you give appropriate credit to the original author(s), provide a link to the license, and indicate if changes were made.



Sarah von Grebmer zu Wolfsthurn
Open Science Center at LMU Munich

- Background in (clinical and neuro-) psychology (UK, NL)
- PhD in cognitive psychology and neurolinguistics in H2020 project (NL)
- Joined the OSC in January 2025 as Open Science Program Coordinator
 - **Coordinating, developing and delivering** the “**Train-the-trainer**” program
 - **Facilitating** interdisciplinary workshops, seminars, and networking **events**
 - **Supporting** the adoption of open research practices

Today we will cover...

- The academic publishing system (and our relationship with publishers)
- The Why and types of Open Access
- The life cycles of open research papers
- A new vision of academic publishing
- What *you* can do for more transparent research

Bonus content: Predatory publishing

What do you connect with the term
Open Access?

A closed access story

- **Ebola outbreak 2013-2016:**

- > 11,000 deaths, mainly in Liberia, Sierra Leone, and Guinea
- Detection of the outbreak was **delayed** because doctors did not know it was present in the area
- But: A **1982** scientific article (Ivanoff et al., 1982) had predicted the outbreak
- Article was hidden behind a **paywall** (45\$ = half week's salary of a local physician)
- In response to publicly raised criticism, Elsevier lifted the paywall

... **only** for Ebola-related papers ...

... **for 2 months**





Sylvain ❄️ 🎓
@DevilleSy



Explain academic publishing to me like I am Five

[Tweet übersetzen](#)

7:35 nachm. · 12. Jan. 2020 · [Twitter for iPad](#)



Ned Potter
@ned_potter



Cows make milk. They milk themselves.



Sylvain ❄️ 🧑
@DevilleSy



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Other cows check the milk (for free).

At this point, the product
is fully there.



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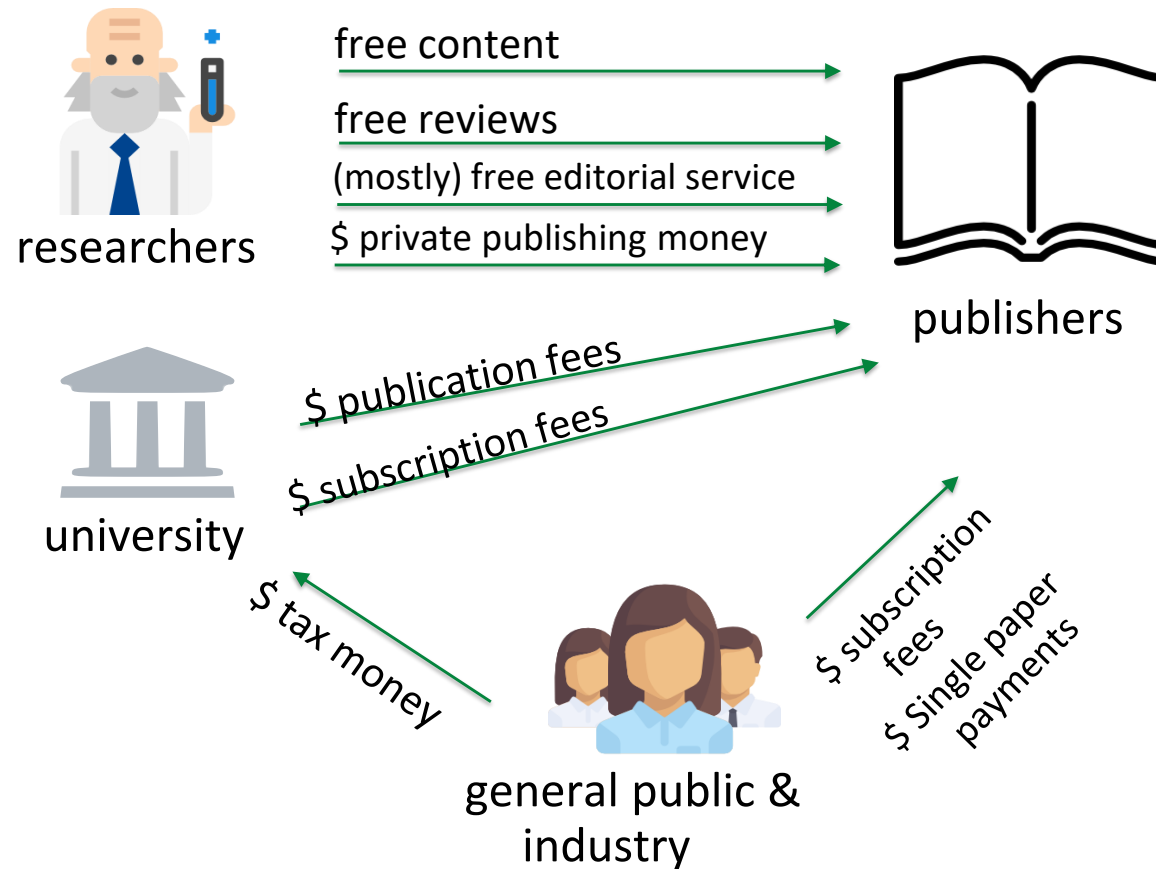
Other cows check the milk (for free).

At this point, the product
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Cows - get this - PAY THE FARMER to take the milk
away.

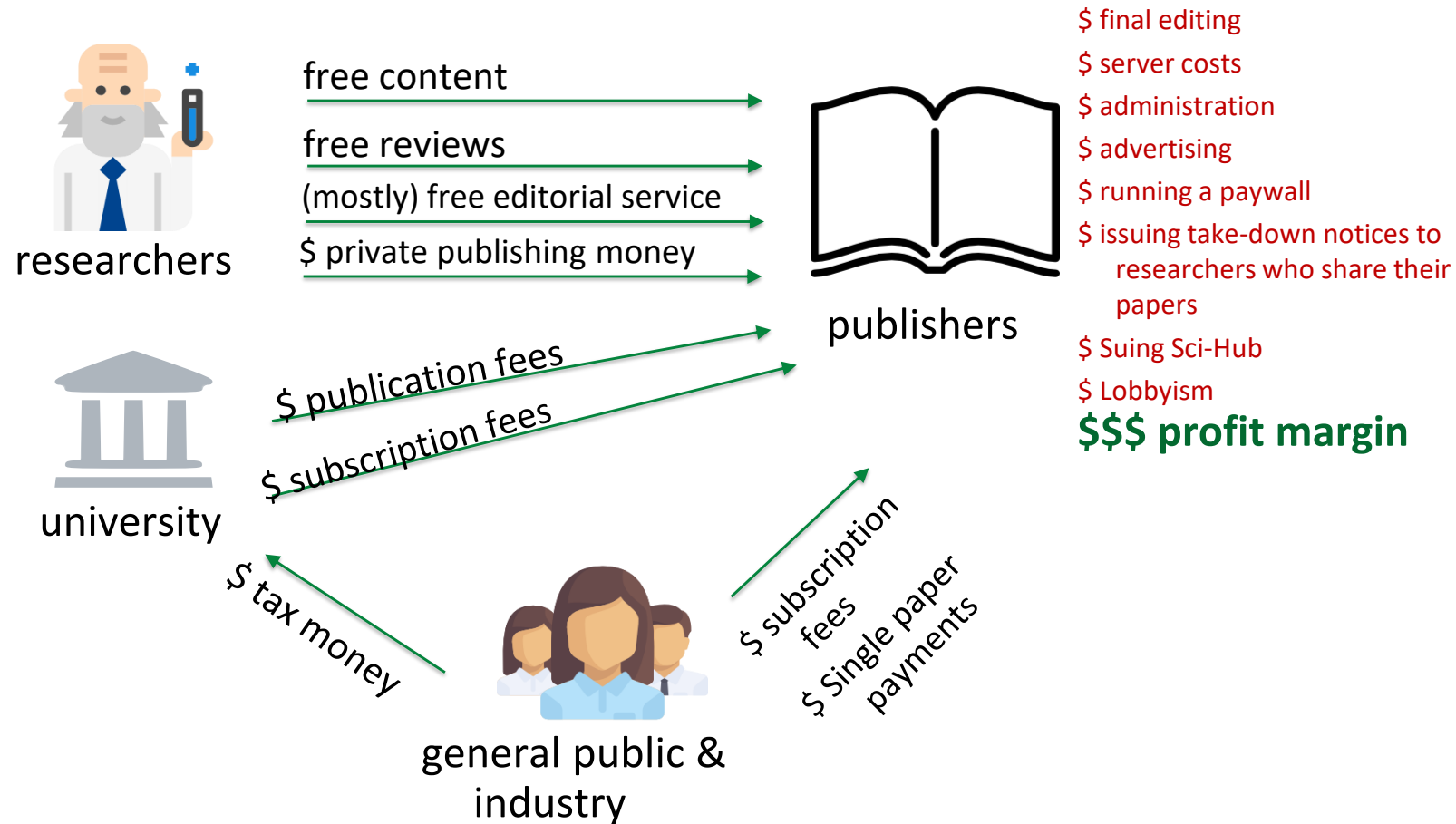
Then the farmer (you won't believe this, honestly) sells
the milk *back to the cows.*

Status quo: How publishers make \$\$\$\$\$



Have you ever paid private money to
publish your manuscript?

Status quo: How publishers make \$\$\$\$\$



Publishing costs

- We (society, researchers) pay on average between **3.800 € and 5.000 € for publishing a paper** (all subscription fees + APCs + payments divided by published papers; *not* counting free labor such as reviewing, editing, etc.)
- „Billion dollar donation“: In 2020, **130 million hours of unpaid reviewing time** were done by scientific community overall; translated to money value with average wages:
 - \$1,510,810,944 (US)
 - \$391,036,638 (UK)
- **Actual costs for publishing one paper (online only, no print): ~ 400 €**
(estimates range between 200 € and 1000 €, see Grossmann et al., 2021)

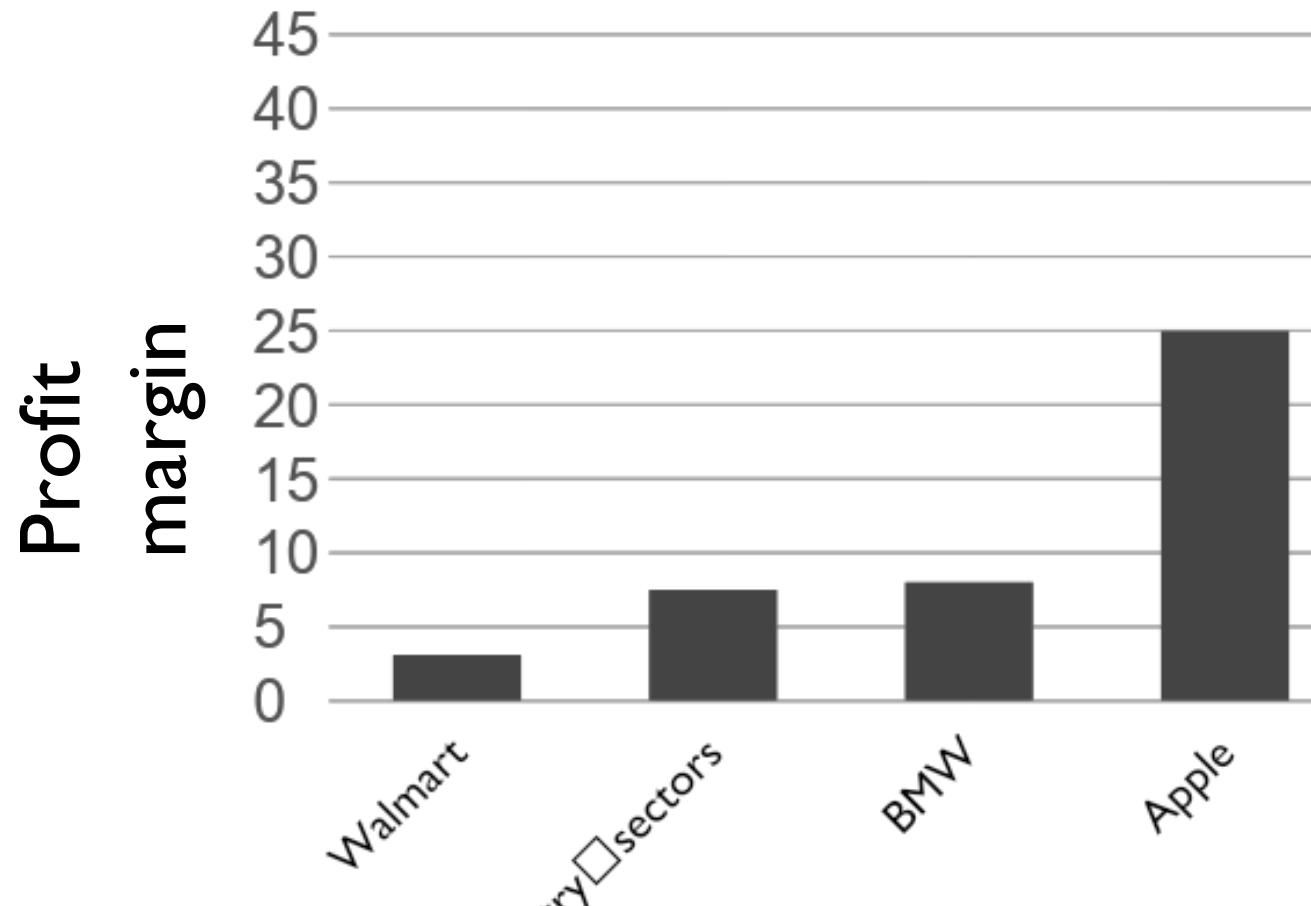
Schimmer, R., Geschuhn, K. K., & Vogler, A. (2015). Disrupting the subscription journals' business model for the necessary large-scale transformation to open access. doi:10.17617/1.3.

Van Noorden, R. (2013). Open access: The true cost of science publishing. Nature News, 495(7442), 426. <https://doi.org/10.1038/495426a>

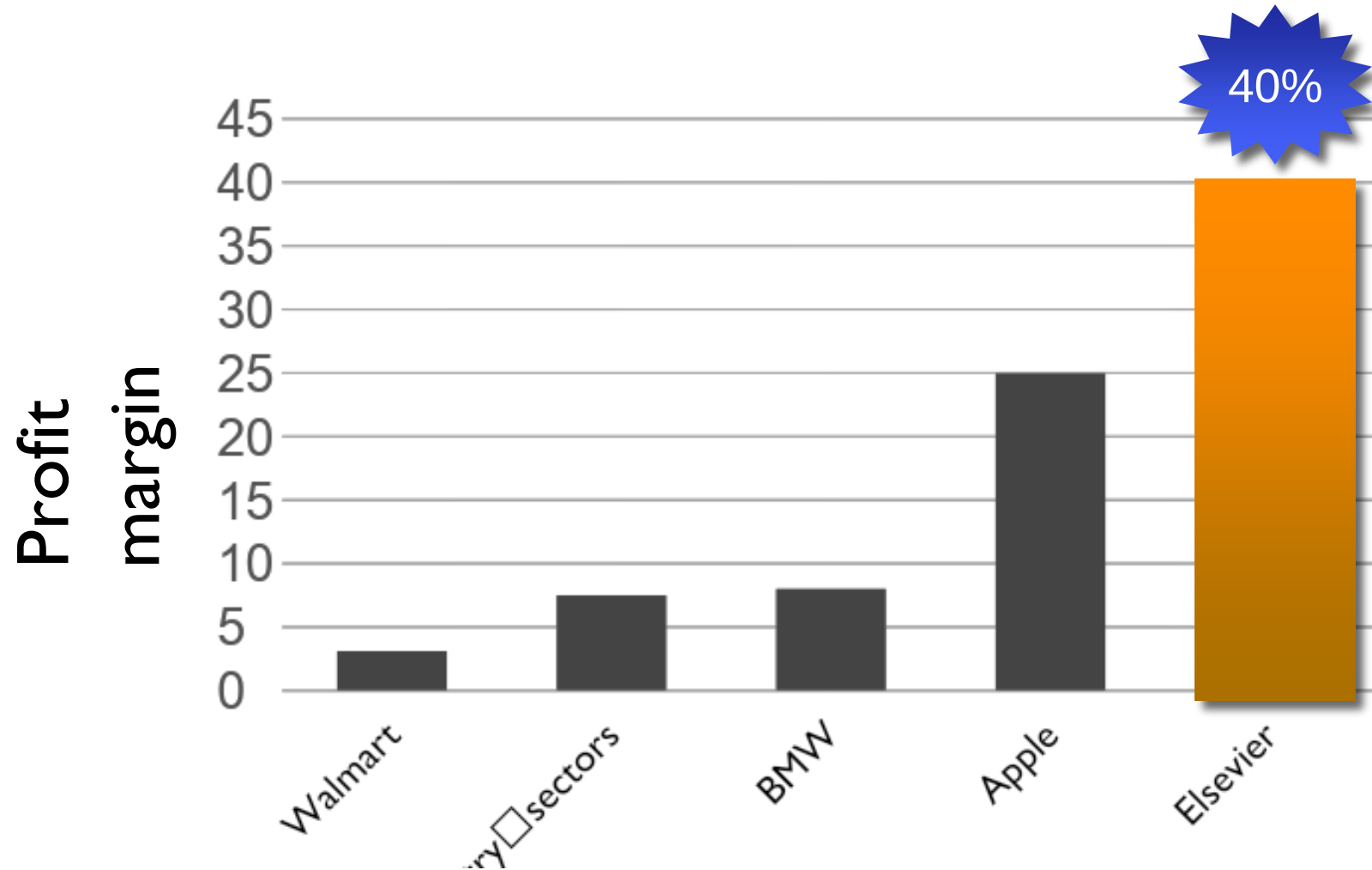
Grossmann, A., & Brembs, B. (2021). Current market rates for scholarly publishing services [version 2; peer review: 2 approved]. F1000Research, 10(20). <https://doi.org/10.12688/f1000research.27468.2>

Aczel, B., Szaszi, B., & Holcombe, A. O. (2021). A billion-dollar donation: Estimating the cost of researchers' time spent on peer review. Research Integrity and Peer Review, 6(1), 14. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s41073-021-00118-2>

Profit margins



Profit margins





Scholars

Trade
„article processing charges“
against
„prestige points“



Publishers

	Price	Prestige points („JIF“)
BMC Psychology	€1625	4.6 
Nature Communications	€6,150	18.1 
Nature Human Behavior	€10850	20.5 

	Price
MIT Press „Data intelligence“	€0
Nature Scientific Data	€2390

Buy the „Nature“ branding

„I published in Nature AND Science!“

JNSCI Journal of Nature and Science
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Science Journal

[Introduction, Call for Papers](#)

Nature and Science

(Nat Sci)

ISSN 1545-0740 (print); ISSN 2375-7167 (online)

[Cover of each issue for print](#)

[Contents of each issue](#)

[Publication ethics and malpractice statement](#)

[an error occurred while
processing this directive]

**Faculty position for neuroscience in
Berlin, German**

Veterinary Science Career

Move your Veterinary Science Career
forward with an online degree!

[WashingtonPost.com/Education](#)

APC: Just 150 \$

What is Open Access?

The Budapest Open Access Initiative (BOAI) Declaration:

- “free availability [of scholarly literature] on the public internet permitting any users to read, download, copy, distribute, print, search, or link to the full texts of these articles, use them for any other lawful purpose, without financial, legal, or technical barriers [...]”
- “the right to be properly acknowledged and cited.”

It is simply: Freely sharing the results of your tax-paid research. Open Access does *not* imply...

... high costs

... lower quality

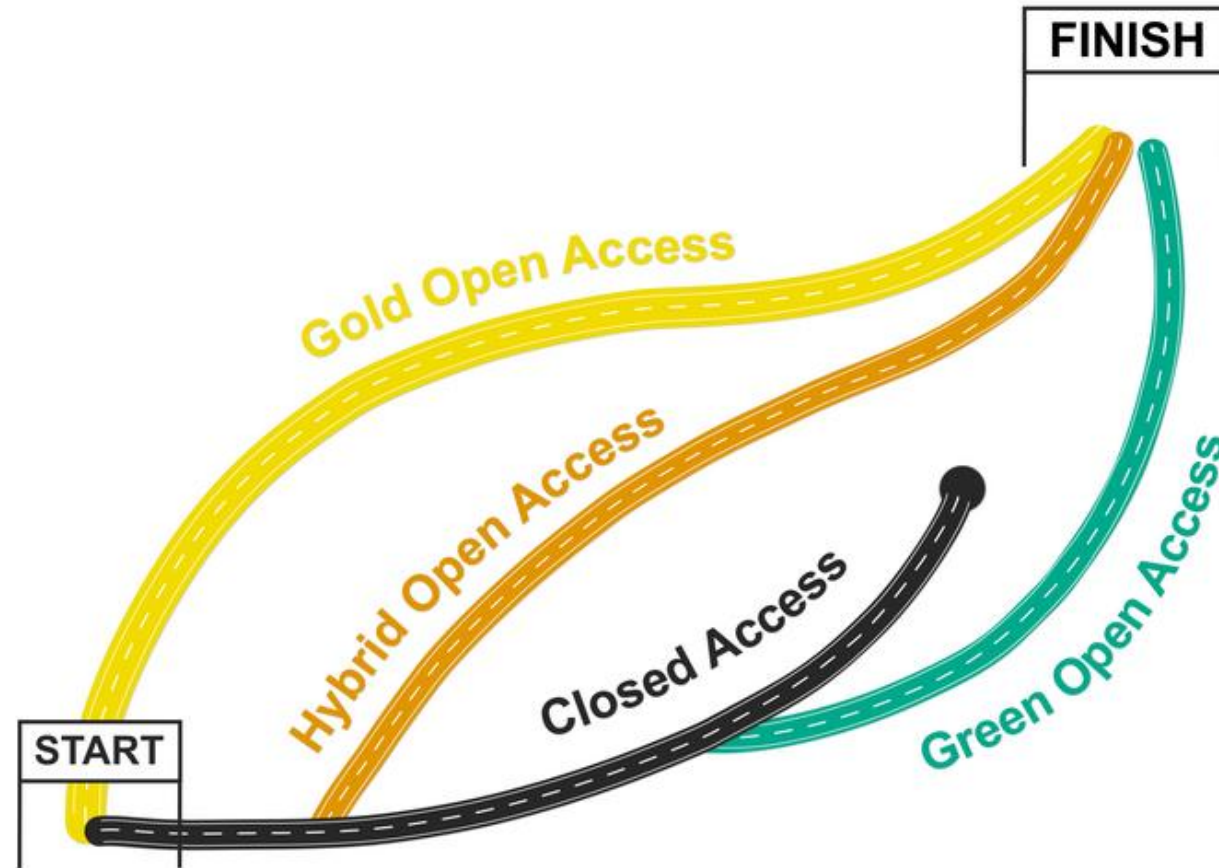
Why Open Access?



CC-BY Danny Kingsley & Sarah Brown

Types of Open Access

Pathways to Open Access

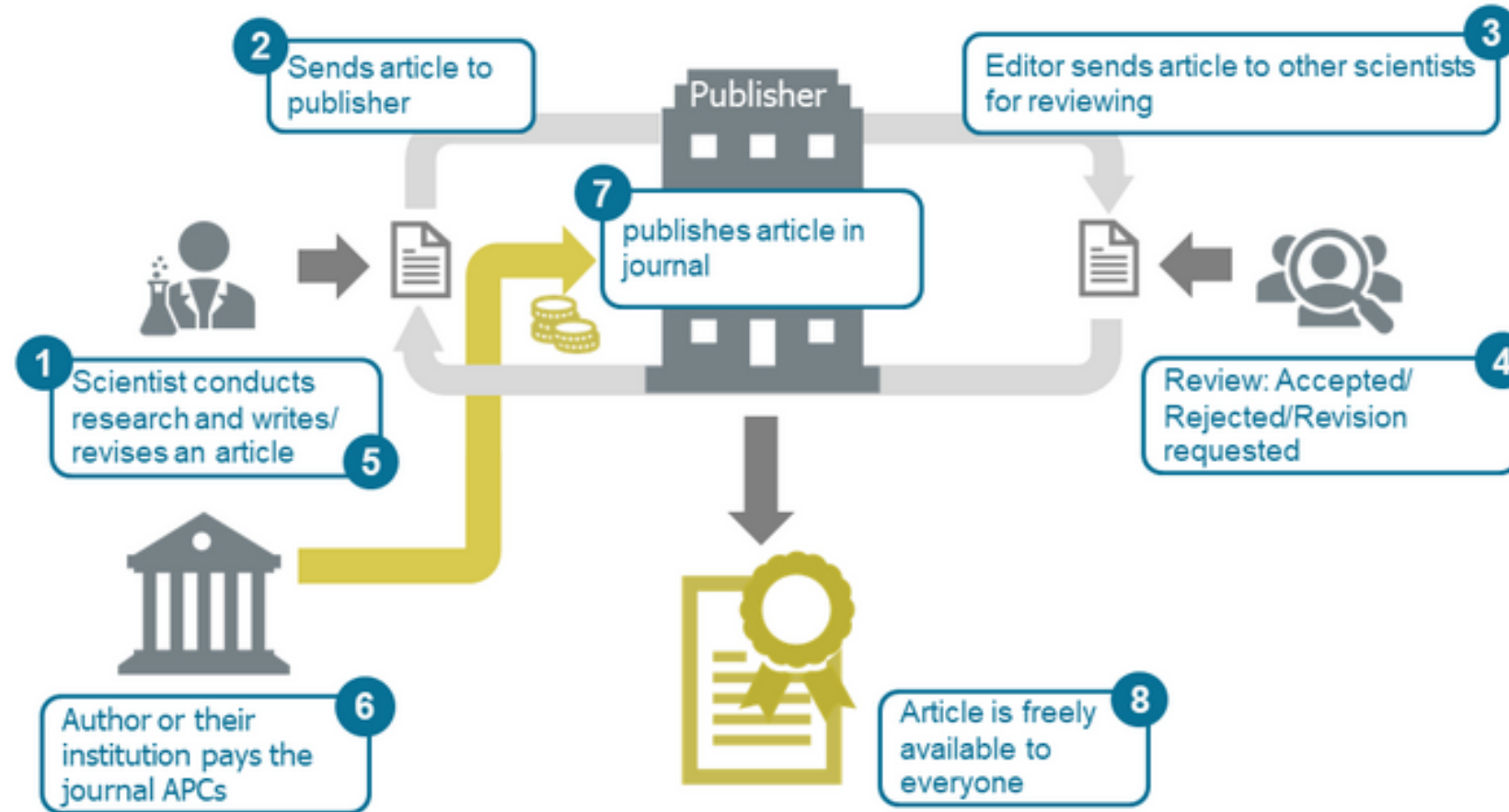


Source: Forschungszentrum Jülich (2015), Open-Access-Strategie des Forschungszentrums Jülich, <https://fz-juelich.de/zb/DE/leistungen/Open_Access/oa_strategy_fzj/oa_strategy_fzj_node.html>, Stand: 03.09.2021

Types of Open Access

	Description	Costs for author	Other/hidden costs	Where is the PDF?	Look of PDF	Example (prices from 08/2026)
Bronze	Journals make articles free to read on their website, but without open license, and without right to download or share	0 €	(depends - usually subscription fees)	Journal's website	Formatted journal's layout	Nature ReadCube
Gold	Journals that are entirely open access; authors pay article processing charges (APCs)	typically 600 € - 5000 €	0 €	Journal's website	Formatted journal's layout	PLOS ONE (APC 1800 Euros)
Green	Self-archiving of the pre- or postprint in repositories or private websites	0 €	(depends - usually subscription fees)	Open Repository	Author's version (Word, Latex, etc)	Science
Diamond / Platinum	Open access journals without APCs	0 €	Institutions pay for journal maintenance costs	Journal's website	Formatted journal's layout	Social Psychological Bulletin (on PsychOpen platform) Open Journals LMU

Scholarly Publishing: Gold Open Access

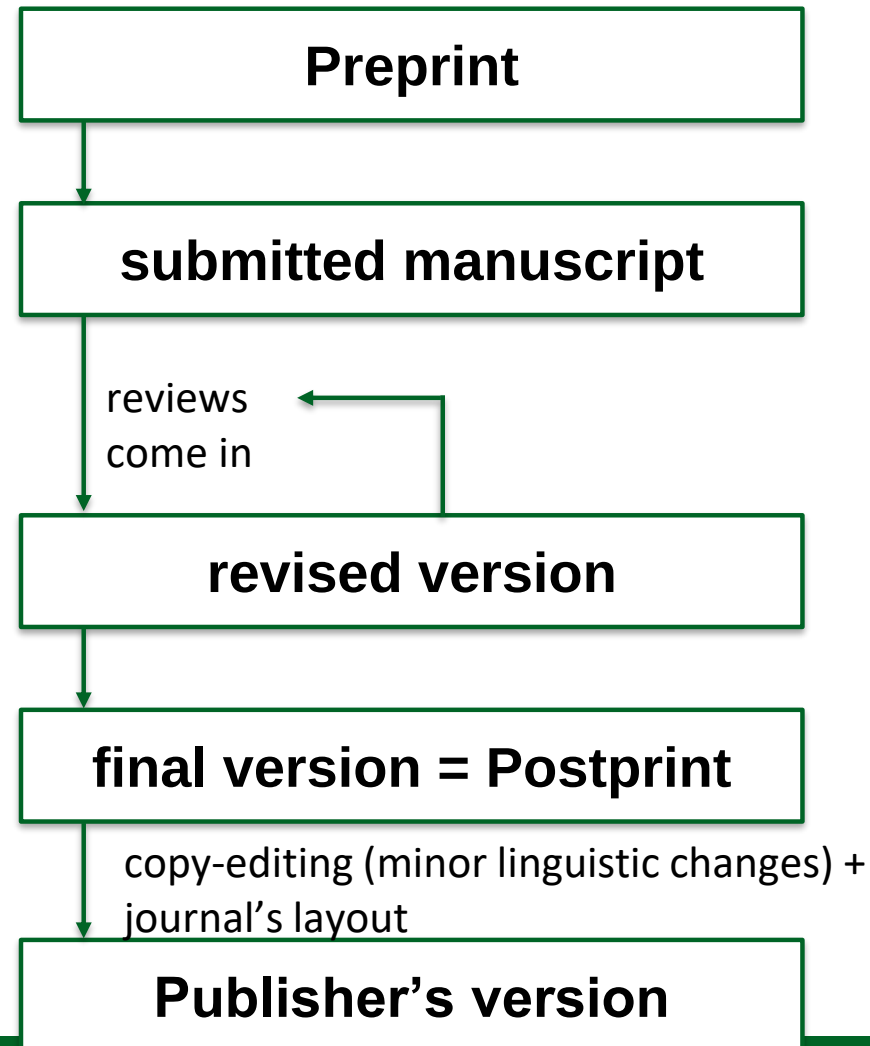


Source: Based on Oberländer, Anja (2020). Open Access – Es ist nicht alles Gold, was glänzt. In: Open Science. Von Daten zu Publikationen. Zenodo. <http://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.4018594>

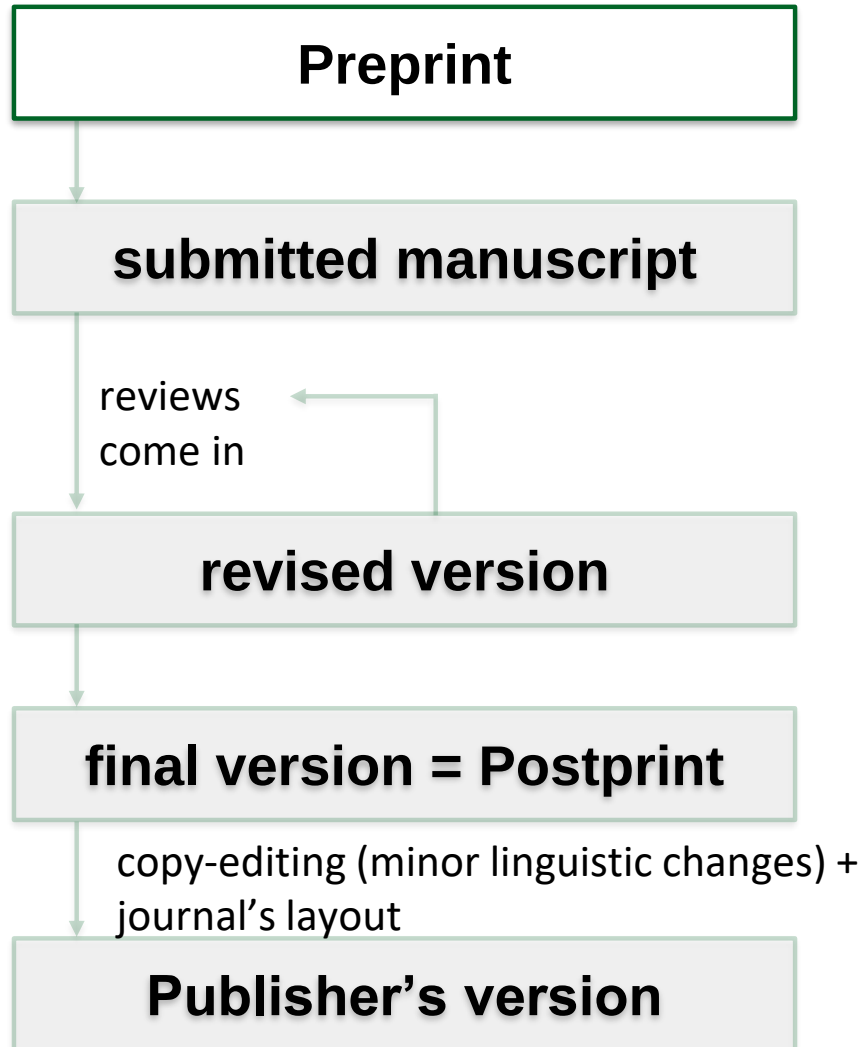
Free your research!

- At the end, **every OA publication** (gold, green, diamond) can be **read freely** by everybody → the main difference is in **financing**
- If green OA is possible - why pay at all? Make your research free for no extra costs (and without throwing more money at publishers)
 - But: Funding agencies might have regulations (e.g., embargo periods)
- Moral obligation to release your research **as green OA** wherever possible
 - = **Self-archiving pre- and/or postprint**

The Green OA publishing route



The Green OA publishing route



Preprint = manuscript *before* peer review
a.k.a. „the author’s original manuscript (AOM)

Before finalizing manuscript:

- Check if journal allows preprints:
<https://openpolicyfinder.jisc.ac.uk/>
- Upload to **preprint server**
- Get a **doi** to cite the preprint
- Clearly **mark the PDF as preprint**, e.g.:
DRAFT - not peer-reviewed

*Optionally: Ask for feedback on social media
(external review)*

Example: Preprint

Testing similarity effects with dyadic response surface analysis

Felix D. Schönbrodt
Ludwig-Maximilians-University, Munich

Sarah Humberg
Münster University

Steffen Nestler
Leipzig University

Dyadic similarity effect hypotheses state that the (dis)similarity between dyad members (e.g., the similarity on a personality dimension) is related to a dyadic outcome variable (e.g., the relationship satisfaction of both partners). Typically, these hypotheses have been investigated by using difference scores or other profile similarity indices as predictors of the outcome variables. These approaches, however, have been vigorously criticized for their conceptual and statistical shortcomings. Here, we introduce a statistical method that is based on polynomial regression and addresses most of these shortcomings: Dyadic response surface analysis (DRSA). This model is tailored for similarity effect hypotheses and fully accounts for the dyadic nature of relationship data. Furthermore, we provide a tutorial with an illustrative example and reproducible R and Mplus scripts that should assist substantive researchers in precisely formulating, testing, and interpreting their dyadic similarity effect hypotheses.

Unpublished manuscript, draft version 0.2, 2018-07-10.

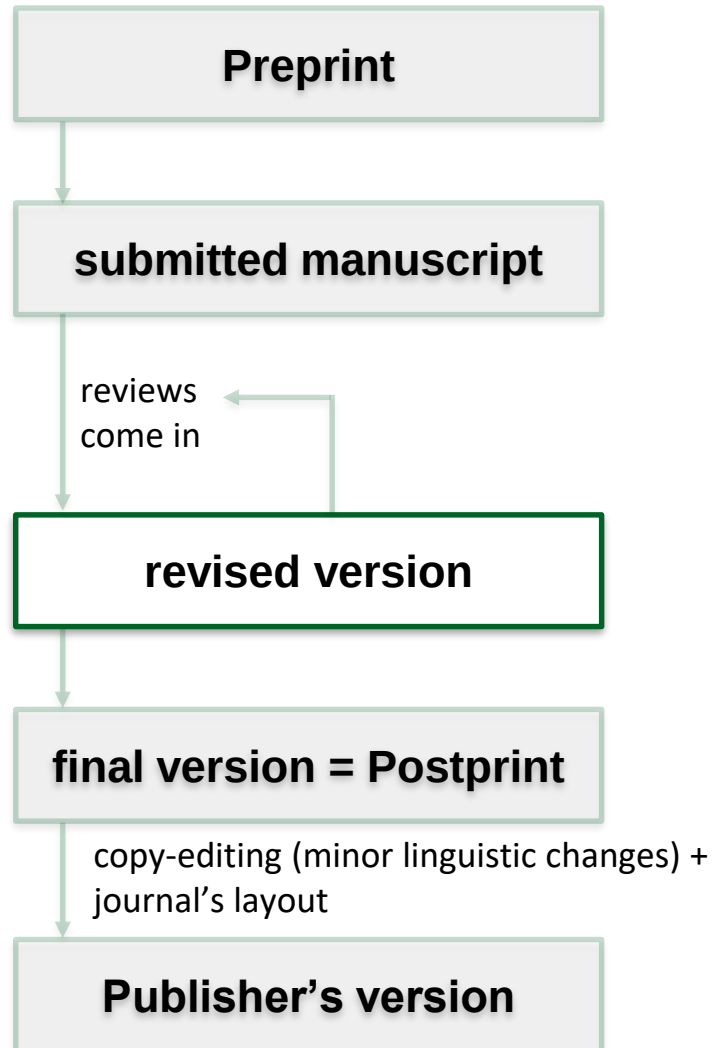
Keywords: congruence, similarity, dyadic data, response surface analysis, polynomial regression

A number of interesting psychological research questions in dyadic contexts refer to the effects of the dyad members' similarity on some outcome. For example, how is the similarity between the husband's and wife's personality associ-

related to two outcome variables stemming from the same dyad members. Hence, we do not focus on the question whether or how similar dyad members are in absolute terms, but rather on the effect of different levels of similarity (on

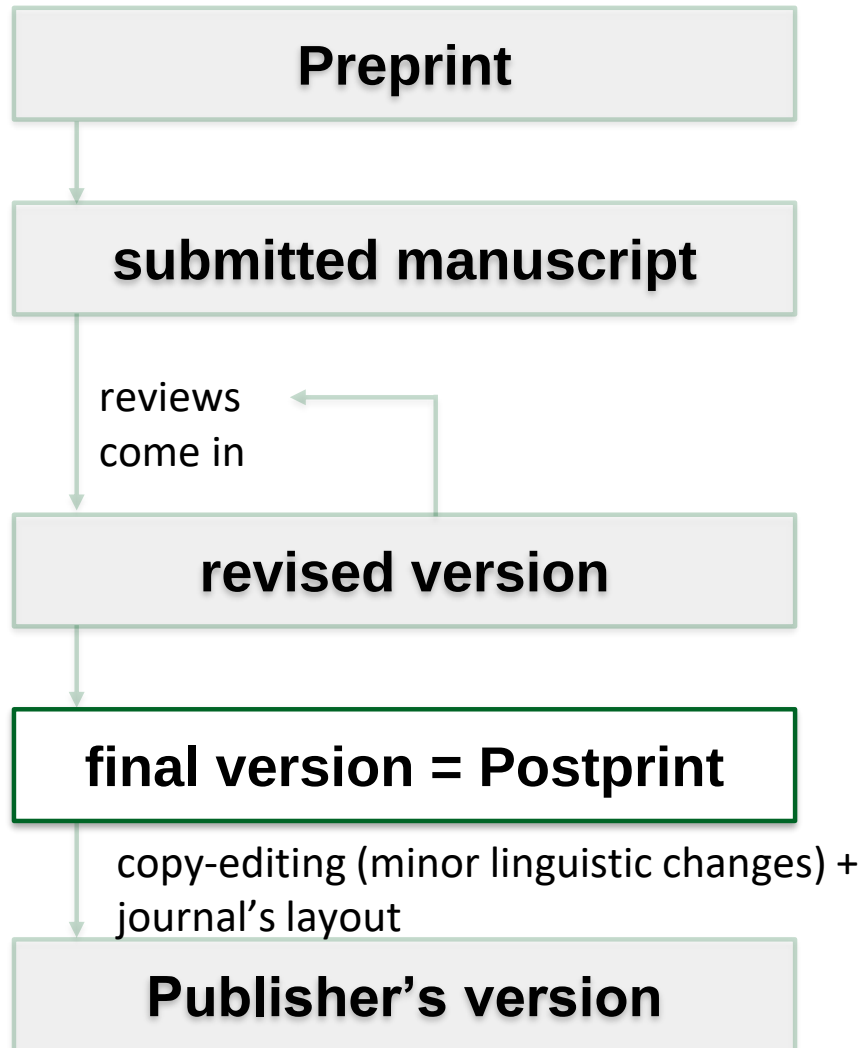
Even better:
"Unpublished manuscript,
version 0.2 (2020-05-07), NOT
peer-reviewed.
Cite at your own risk."

The Green OA publishing route



- *Optionally:* Update preprint on preprint server with revised version
 - Make a note on the front page that this is a **revised** version
 - (technically, a revised version is somewhere between pre- and postprint)

The Green OA publishing route



Post-print = accepted version after review, but before layouting. a.k.a. the accepted manuscript (AM)

Before final submission to journal for copyediting

a. Check if journal allows post-prints:

<https://openpolicyfinder.jisc.ac.uk/>

b. Update PDF on preprint server with the post-print

c. Clearly mark the PDF as postprint.

d. Distribute the link to the open access version to colleagues etc. Put OA link on your website.

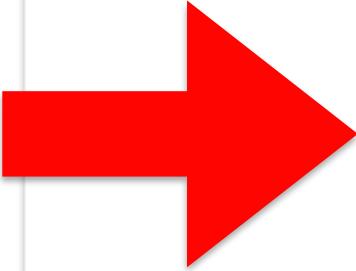
Example: Postprint

Testing similarity effects with dyadic response surface analysis

Felix D. Schönbrodt
Ludwig-Maximilians-University, Munich

Sarah Humberg
Münster University

Steffen Nestler
Leipzig University



This is an unedited manuscript accepted for publication in the *European Journal of Personality*. The manuscript will undergo copyediting, typesetting, and review of resulting proof before it is published in its final form.

Please cite as:

Schönbrodt, F. D., Humberg, S., Nestler, S. (2018). Testing Similarity Effects with Dyadic Response Surface Analysis. *European Journal of Personality*. doi:10.1002/per.2169

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Open policy finder
Formerly Sherpa services

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Me



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Nature

Publisher [Nature Research](#) | ISSN 0028-0836 | eISSN 1476-4687

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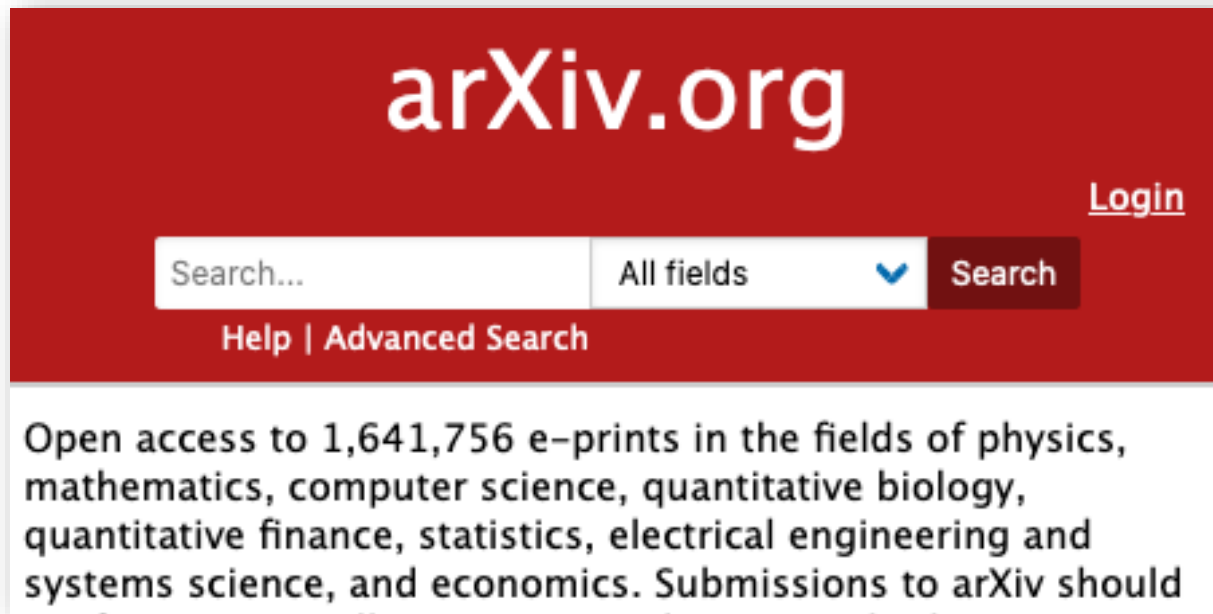
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Pre- and postprint servers



<https://arxiv.org/>

bioRxiv

THE PREPRINT SERVER FOR BIOLOGY

Search 
Advanced Search

<https://www.biorxiv.org/>

Pre- and postprint servers: OSF



Preprint Services

Leading preprint service providers use this open source infrastructure to support their communities.



Hettne et al. 2021. A Practical Guide to Preprints: Accelerating Scholarly Communication (1.0). Zenodo.

<https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.5600535>

In contrast to *ResearchGate* and *academia.edu* these are non-commercial services!

Pre- and postprint servers: OSF

thematic_analysis_preprint.pdf

Version: 1

Download previous
version

Submitted: August 10, 2026 | Last edited : August 10, 2026

https://osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/7dr9y_v1

The screenshot shows a web interface for a preprint on PsyArXiv. At the top, there's a navigation bar with a home icon, the path "/ Preprints / PsyArXiv / 7dr9y_v1", and a "Sign in" button. Below this, the preprint title "The Learner's Appraisal: What Are Students Thinking About When Their Mind Wanders?" is displayed next to the PsyArXiv logo. To the right of the title are download and share icons. A central viewer displays the first page of the PDF, which includes the title, authors (Daniel Ebbert, Negin Mirriahi, Alrike Claassen, Natasha Wilson, Srecko Joksimovic, and Shane Dawson), contact information (daniel.ebbert@adelaide.edu.au), and a disclaimer that the version has not been peer-reviewed. To the right of the viewer, there are sections for "Authors" (listing the same names), "Abstract" (starting with "Learners will inevitably think about something other than what they"), and a "Read more" link. Below the viewer, there's a "Preprint DOI" section showing "Version: 1" and the DOI link "https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/7dr9y_v1", along with a note about DOI minting. Further down, it shows "Views: 22 | Downloads: 52". At the bottom right, there's a "License" section for "CC-BY Attribution 4.0 International" and a "Subjects" section with the tag "Learner". A "Help" button is visible on the right side of the page.

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PsyArXiv The Learner's Appraisal: What Are Students Thinking About When Their Mind Wanders? [Download](#) [Share](#)

Authors
Daniel Ebbert, Negin Mirriahi, Alrike Claassen, Natasha Wilson, Srecko Joksimovic, Shane Dawson

Abstract
Learners will inevitably think about something other than what they

[Read more](#) [? Help](#)

following off-task thoughts will depend on how they appraise these thoughts.

Keywords: mind wandering, task-unrelated thoughts, thought appraisal, thought content

Introduction
While learning, students will inevitably find their attention drawn away from the task at hand (Sharpe & Tyndall, 2025). This experience is often called mind wandering, or more precisely, task-unrelated thoughts. Task-unrelated thoughts occur about 30% of the time during learning and are negatively associated with content retention (Wong et al., 2022). However, task-unrelated thoughts are not the only thoughts that occur during learning (Smallwood & Schooler, 2015). Other categories that have been studied include task-related interference (Stawarczyk et al., 2011), lecture-related off-task thoughts (Kane et al., 2017), external distractions (Ebbert et al., 2024), or autobiographical memories (Baird et al., 2011). These categories have typically been assessed through experience sampling methods using closed-response probes, in which

Preprint DOI
Version: 1
https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/7dr9y_v1
DOIs are minted by a third party, and may take up to 24 hours to be registered.

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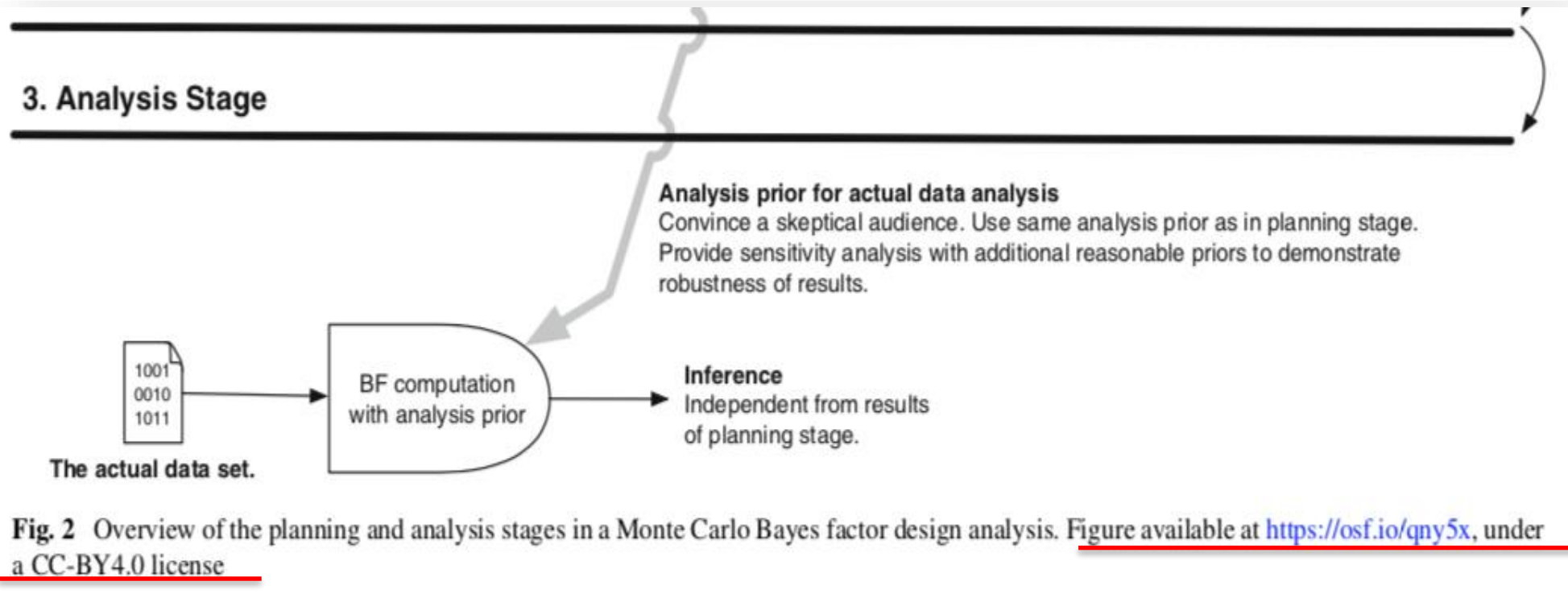
Subjects
Learner

I have a preprint
(or a postprint).
So what..?

Contributing to a new way of academic publishing

- Preprints and postprints (marked as such) are **free to be used** by anyone
 - Content is **not locked** behind paywalls
 - There is a **record** of versions
 - Higher **visibility** → more **citations**
 - ...with **licenses** to ensure that you get credit
- Not only articles to be deposited on preprint servers! Also images, analysis scripts, plots and figures ... → **for reproducibility**

Researcher life hack: Free your images!



Publish your figures under a free license (prior to submission), and then you give the license to the journal (not the other way round).

A vision for the future of academic publishing

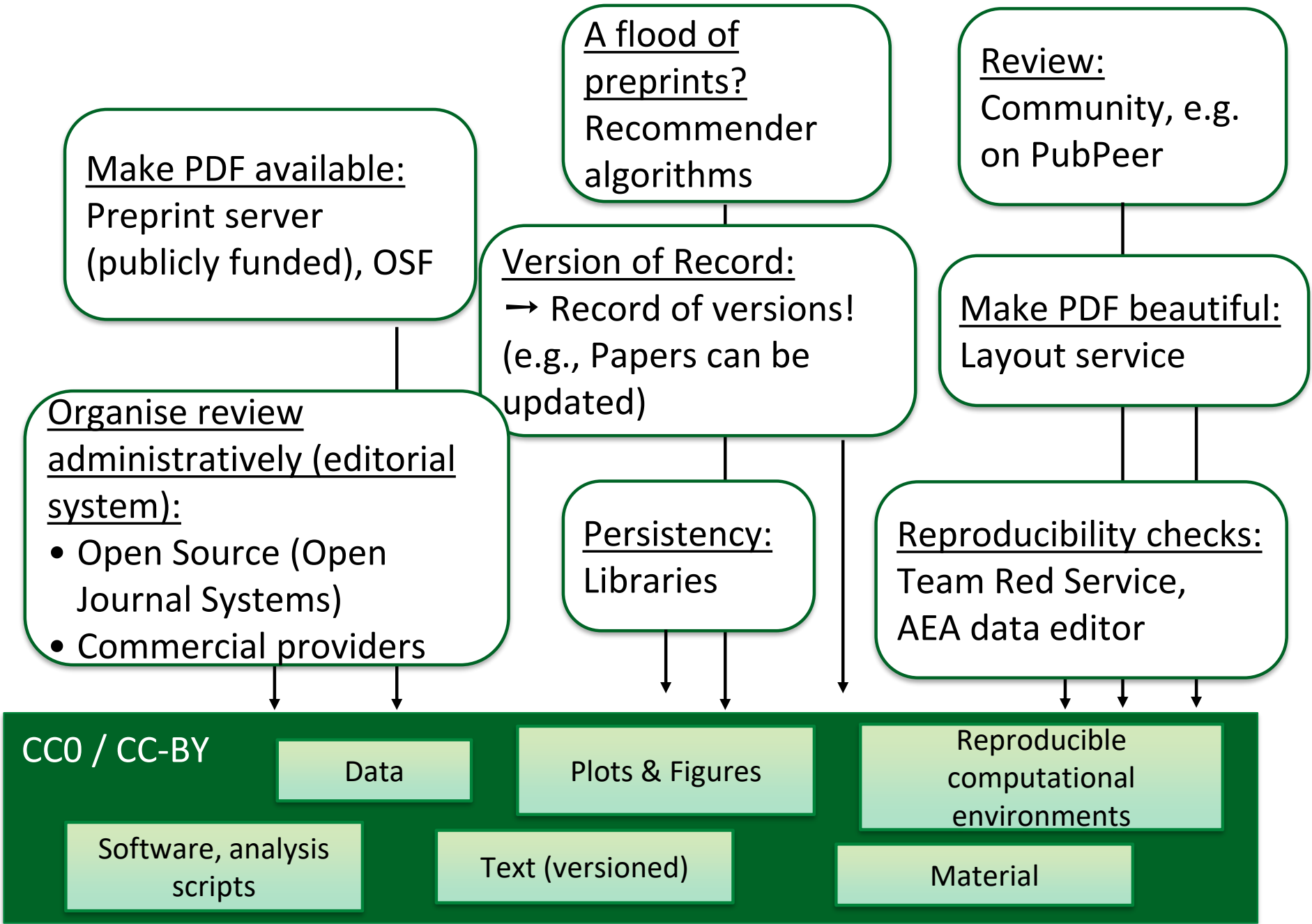
Brembs, B., Huneman, P., Schönbrodt, F., Nilsonne, G., Susi, T., Siems, R., Perakakis, P., Trachana, V., Ma, L., & Rodriguez-Cuadrado, S. (2023). **Replacing academic journals**. *Royal Society Open Science*, 10(7), 230206. <https://doi.org/10.1098/rsos.230206>

An open market:

Services that compete with each other, operating on the open content.

(often there are public alternatives, possibly better commercial offers?)

Content is stored in a **public backbone**, has an open license and is based on interoperable, open standards (defined by the scientific community).

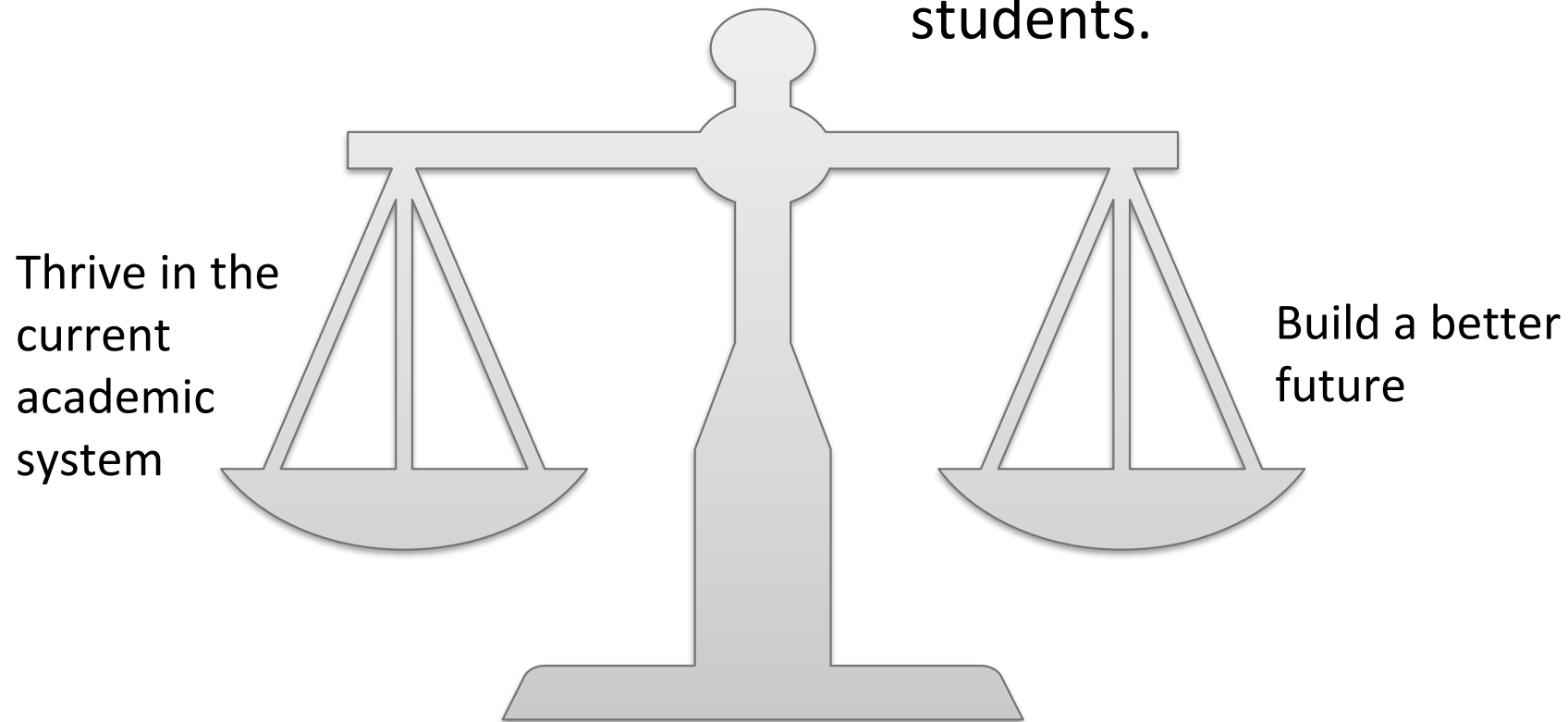


Scholarly-led and scholarly-owned publishing

- The content backbone is run **scholarly-led** and **scholarly-owned** by **non-profit** and publicly financed stakeholders.
- The content is **free to use** by anyone, ...
- designed in a way that **prevents vendor lock-in** by using open standards and licenses, allowing portability between service providers.
- These modular components are not necessarily located at a single service provider but can be **distributed across distinct but interoperable services**.

I get it, but if I want a career in academia, I have to play the game!

*,,, and when I am tenured myself,
I have to play the game for my PhD
students.



What could **everybody*** do?

* without hampering your career.

- Don't play the game of glamour magz
(e.g., when you introduce external speakers, don't mention the outlet)
- Allocate your reviewing time to open platforms
(e.g., in diamond open access journals)
- **Always publish your post-prints as Green OA.**
(unless impossible). Don't pay unnecessary Gold OA fees!
- When you apply for a grant or a position: Make your publishing strategy explicit:

—„For the following reasons I decided to submit my scientific work mostly to diamond open access journals with quality assurance: ... I ask the committee to evaluate the quality of my work based on its intrinsic merits, and not based on where it is published.“

What could **PIs/supervisors*** do?

- **Mentor for responsibility**, not for survival
 - Gopalakrishna et al. (2022): Survey of 6,813 researchers in the Netherlands:
“mentoring for survival” predicts QRPs (positively), „mentoring for responsibility“ predicts QRPs negatively
- **Publish** (some of) your **best work in Diamond OA journals**
- **Devote your service** (editorial work) to open journals/platforms
- As PhD supervisors (or “Doktorvater/mutter”):
 - What kind of academic environment do you want to create and leave for your “offspring”?

*Hey, you are in a position to actually change the system!

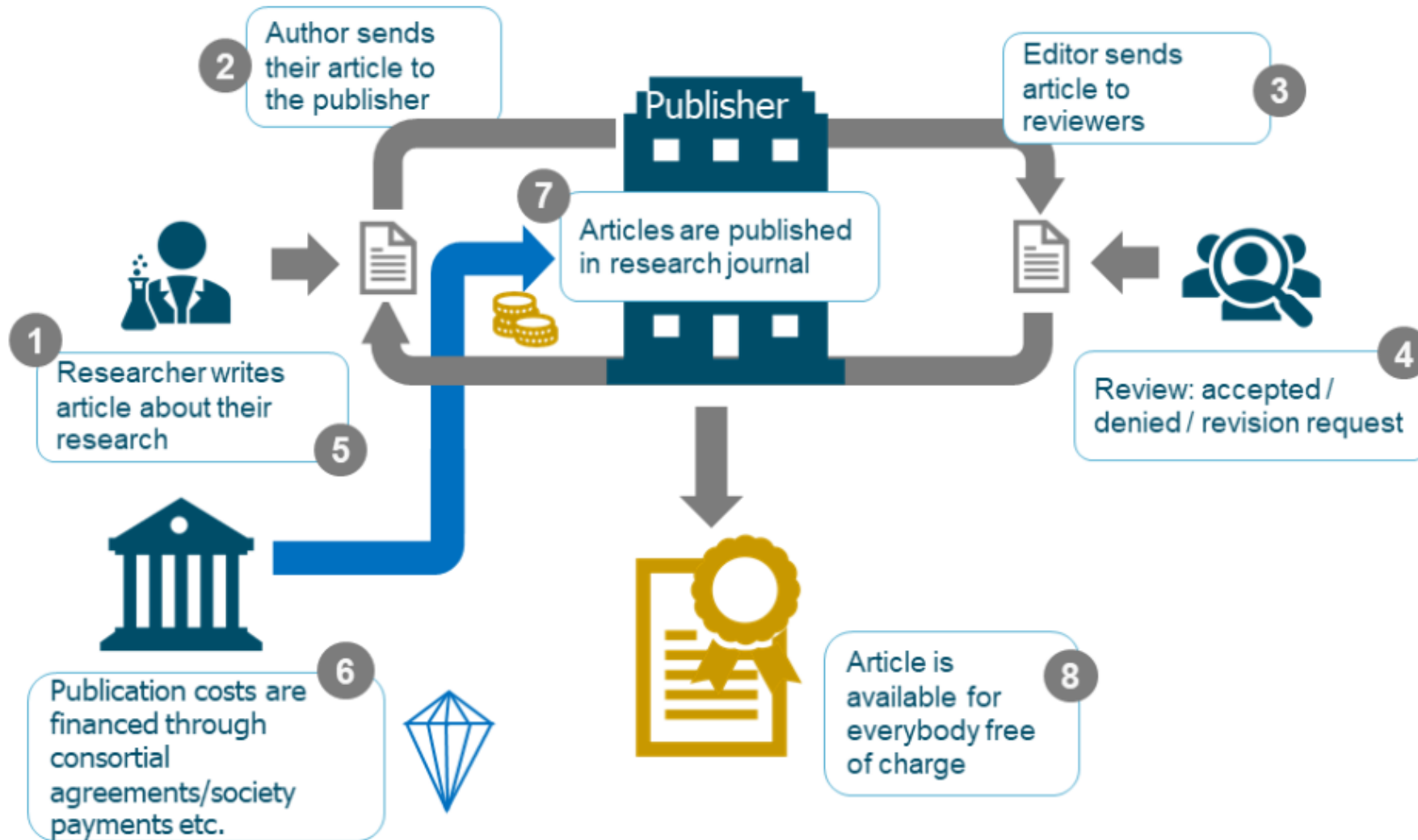
What could **institutions** do?

- **Change evaluation practice** in hiring and promotion: Don't use the journal impact factor (JIF). See [DGPs initiative](#) / [DORA](#) / [CoARA](#)
 - In job ad: „*The Department of Psychology values transparent, robust, and replicable research.[...] Please do not report journal impact factors, the committee does not use them in evaluation.*“
- **Do not use JIF** in agreements/goals for habilitations/dissertations.
- **Remove JIF** entirely from performance-based money allocation.
- **Retrospectively** make all publications of the department **available as Green OA** (can be done by student assistant + help from library).

How to ... Diamond OA!

- Find Diamond OA journal
 - <https://pub.uni-bielefeld.de/record/2963331#details>
 - <https://doaj.org/>
 - Check “No fees” and double-check author rights!
- **Free for authors to and readers to publish and access articles**
 - No subscription fees
 - No article processing fees
- Aligns with the [UNESCO 2021 Recommendation on Open Science](#) regarding open scientific knowledge and scientific publications

Scientific Publishing: Diamond Open Access



Questions / comments / concerns?

Thanks so much! 😊

Reach out if you have any comments or questions!

LMU OSC: <https://www.osc.lmu.de/>

Developing your Open Research **teaching skills:**

<https://lmu-osc.github.io/train-the-trainer-open-research/>

Self-paced tutorials on Open Research skills:

<https://www.osc.lmu.de/training/self-learning.html>

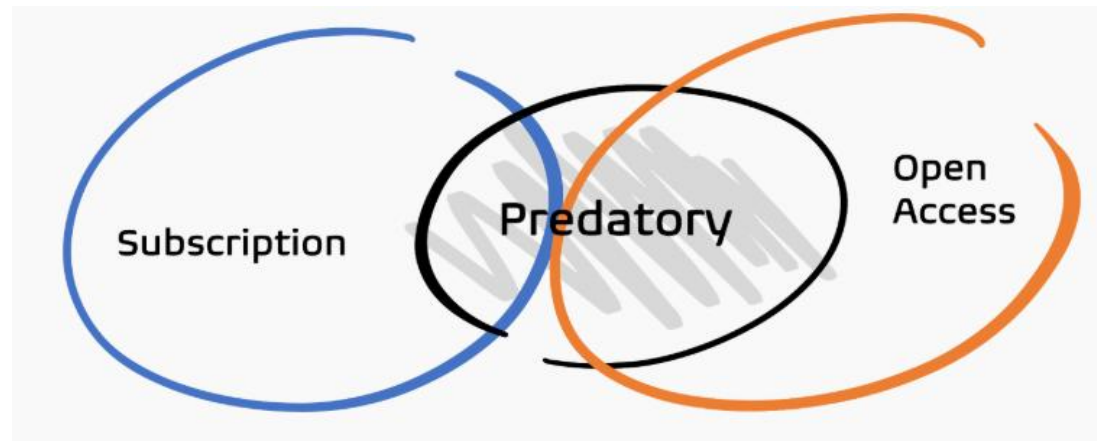
Bonus slides

Open Policy Finder - Example

- <https://openpolicyfinder.jisc.ac.uk/publication> contains information about:
 - Open-access policy
 - Whether the publisher allows self-archiving
 - Embargo periods
 - Licence requirements
 - ...

Predatory publishing

- **Predatory publishing** = “an **exploitative** business model that involves **charging publication fees** to authors **without** checking articles for quality and legitimacy”
 - Compromises the credibility and integrity of scientific research (Shen et al., 2023)



Predatory publishing

- **Predatory publishing** increases the amount of freely available low-quality research outputs
 - Does not only affect open access publishing, but also the rise of “paper mills”

World View | Published: 12 September 2012

Predatory publishers are corrupting open access

[Jeffrey Beall](#) 

[Nature](#) **489**, 179 (2012) | [Cite this article](#)

Diamond access and predatory publishing

- see  **THINK**  **CHECK**  **SUBMIT**
- Diamond OA *cannot* be predatory!
(Because no profit is made)

Is it clear what fees will be charged?

- ☐ Does the journal site explain what these fees are for and when they will be charged?
- ☐ Does the publisher explain on their website how they are financially supported?
- ☐ Do they mention the currency and amount of any fees?
- ☐ Does the publisher website explain whether or not waivers are available?

Are guidelines provided for authors on the publisher website?

- ☐ For open access journals, does the publisher have a clear license policy? Are there preferred licenses? Are there exceptions permitted depending on the needs of the author? Are license details included on all publications?
- ☐ Does the publisher allow you to retain copyright of your work? Can you share your work via, for example, an institutional repository, and under what terms?

References

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